



Avid FreeDV will nag you to buy the professional versions, but is still a very good editor

import their clips to! Take this as a warning: this software seems to be built mainly to showcase the features of the other tools that Avid makes—sort of like a teaser for professionals to show them what they're missing out on.

You should definitely go through the tutorials on the site, and the help files in the software itself before you begin anything. Once you start getting used to the software, however, you will find that it is quite powerful. It's fast too, though perhaps not as fast as VirtualDub, but obviously more feature-rich out of the box.

The biggest advantage is the fact that it is made for both Mac and PC, and thus when editing with a multi-platform computer setup, this is one software that will keep your video editing safe from platform dependence. It's free, providing you register on Avid's site and get the complimentary license key. It's still no match for Adobe's Premiere Pro or Avid's own Xpress Pro, but it certainly does a good job with some cool options such as 16 customisable, real-time effects; a drag-and-drop interface; superimposition of video (video on video); and support for MOV files.